



Dr. REINE YOUSSEF

Executive Leadership | Education | Sustainability | Strategic Government & Institutional Advisory
Public Relations & Cross-Sector Partnerships

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Multilingual senior executive with 25+ years of international experience in higher education, government, and global development. Proven leader in strategy, institutional transformation, and cross-sector partnerships, particularly across the MENA region. Strong track record in advising senior leadership, aligning policy with national agendas, and engaging high-level stakeholders. Brings a global perspective shaped by living and working in Lebanon, Germany, Australia, China, and Saudi Arabia.

BACKGROUND

Education

PhD/Doctorate in Environmental Education
magna cum laude
M.A. Science Education
Teaching Diploma Science Education
B.S. Biology

Sectors

Private, Government, Diplomacy
Multinational Donors, Development Agencies

Academia & Higher Institutions

Education, Environment, Health, Development
& Sustainability

Languages

Arabic (native)
French, English, German, Spanish, & Armenian

EXPERTISE

Strategic Leadership

University Leadership & Academic Strategy
Organizational Leadership & Institutional Development
Sustainability Strategy & Policy
Strategic Advising & Government Relations

External Engagement & Influence

Strategic Communication & Public Relations
Community Outreach & Advocacy
Representation & Diplomacy
Fundraising & Resource Development

Operations & Implementation

Program Management & Project Implementation
Financial Management & Budgeting
Information Management & Reporting

People & Organizational Development

Human Resources Management & Team Development
Training & Capacity Building

WORK EXPERIENCE

Sustainability Awareness and Integration Consultant

Royal Commission for AIUla, Saudi Arabia

Feb 2023 – Present

- Spearhead the strategic planning and execution of a county-wide sustainability awareness campaign, aligning with national development goals and local community priorities.
- Lead cross-functional stakeholder engagement by developing tailored content and communication assets for diverse audiences, including internal leadership, government partners, and external entities.
- Provide expert counsel on sustainability integration, ensuring that sustainability requirements are embedded in core operations and decision-making across RCU departments.
- Drive continuous performance optimization through comprehensive reporting, risk analysis, and sustainability mainstreaming across organizational functions.
- Review and guide project designs to meet sustainability benchmarks, aligning infrastructure and planning with long-term environmental and institutional goals.
- Collaborate with the Innovation Department to introduce advanced technologies and data-driven solutions to enhance environmental performance and strategic outcomes.

- Lead the department's Governance, Risk, and Compliance (GRC) portfolio, including oversight of internal audits-ensuring institutional integrity and alignment with global best practices.

Strategic Advisor to the Minister

Ministry of Information, Office of the Minister, Lebanon

May 2022 - Dec 2022

- Served as a key strategic advisor to the Minister, delivering high-level analysis and insights on national policy programs and media governance initiatives.
- Conducted critical evaluations of policy proposals, decision papers, and programmatic initiatives, offering expert guidance to support informed, forward-looking decision-making.
- Provided consultative services rooted in data-driven analysis and geopolitical awareness, ensuring alignment with broader national objectives and regional dynamics.
- Offered alternative perspectives and strategic foresight to shape communication strategies, institutional reform priorities, and public sector modernization efforts.

Advisor/Senior Program Manager

PwC (Seconded to the Royal Commission for AlUla - Kingdoms Institute Initiative), Saudi Arabia

Oct 2021 - Apr 2022

- Appointed to lead the institutionalization of the Kingdoms Institute, envisioned as the Arab world's premier center of excellence in archaeology, conservation sciences, and heritage research- marking the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia's first dedicated scientific institution in this domain.
- Delivered end-to-end program management across all project phases, ensuring strategic alignment with RCU's long-term vision, Saudi national cultural goals, and KSA's Vision 2030.
- Oversaw strategic planning and operational execution, including development of project charters, governance frameworks, risk registers, and stakeholder engagement strategies.
- Directed stakeholder engagement with senior RCU officials, subject-matter experts, and cross-sector partners to ensure clarity of vision, accountability, and measurable impact.
- Facilitated governance and steering committee meetings, providing regular performance reports, ensuring alignment with key institutional milestones.
- Led budget planning (SAR798m), procurement oversight, and financial closure, ensuring cost-effective delivery and adherence to institutional standards.
- Produced final project documentation, including knowledge transfer materials and lessons learned, to inform future strategic initiatives and institutional replication.

Part-Time Faculty member

Higher Education Institutions in Lebanon

2001 – 2021

- Taught undergraduate and graduate courses in environmental studies, sustainability, science education, and ethics at top Lebanese universities (LAU, Haigazian, AUB, ALBA, Balamand, and Lebanese University).
- Courses: *Seminars in Development, Introduction to Sustainable Environment, Sustainable Cities, Living in the Environment, Community Health Education & Mobilization, Principles of Health Promotion, Issues in Community Health, Teaching Science for Elementary School, Science Instruction & Assessment, Ethics of the Teaching Profession, Curriculum Development, Principles of Communication.*
- Integrated global sustainability goals and ethical leadership into curricula, while mentoring hundreds of students who advanced into careers in government, international organizations, and development.

Director of Development

The American Community School at Beirut (ACS), Lebanon

Jan 2016 - Jun 2017

- Provided strategic leadership for the school's development and advancement efforts, designing and managing comprehensive fundraising campaigns, securing major gifts, grants, and sponsorships to support institutional sustainability and growth.
- Led community outreach, stakeholder engagement, and advocacy initiatives to enhance ACS's visibility, reputation, and influence within the educational, philanthropic, and diplomatic communities.

- Directed communications, marketing, and public relations efforts, overseeing the production of strategic content across digital platforms and traditional media, while organizing high-profile events that advanced the school's mission and public image.
- Collaborated closely with the Business Office to manage development budgets and align financial planning with fundraising objectives and strategic priorities.
- Recruited and managed a multidisciplinary team, including staff, consultants, and volunteers; provided leadership, performance evaluation, and capacity-building support.
- Oversaw development operations, including donor database management, gift processing, compliance with legal and regulatory frameworks, and the implementation of data-driven reporting systems.
- Actively engaged with the school's governance bodies, especially the Board of Trustees' Development Committee, offering strategic counsel and contributing to institutional decision-making as a senior member of the leadership team.
- Partnered with the Admissions Office to align outreach efforts with enrollment goals and to support long-term planning, impact assessment, and community-building initiatives.

Project Manager, National Capacity Self-Assessment for Global Environmental Management

UNDP/GEF - Ministry of Environment, Lebanon

Oct 2005 - Dec 2007

- Led a UNDP/GEF national project to strengthen Lebanon's capacity to implement global environmental conventions (UNFCCC, UNCCD, and UNCBD), overseeing strategic planning, stakeholder coordination, and full project lifecycle management.
- Built cross-sector partnerships with ministries, UN agencies, and civil society; advanced environmental governance through policy advocacy, institutional training, public outreach, and the development of national knowledge platforms.

Director, Public Health & Development Sciences (PHDS) Program

University of Balamand – Faculty of Health Sciences, Lebanon

Sep 2001 - Sep 2005

- Directed the Public Health & Development Sciences program, leading strategic planning, curriculum development, faculty recruitment, and academic operations while fostering student success through mentorship, alumni engagements and career pathways.
- Secured and managed donor-funded development projects with the EU, UN, and public agencies; advanced public health education and policy through high-level partnerships, media advocacy, and national/regional stakeholder engagement. Projects include: - McGovern-Dole Food for Education Program (USDA / IOCC Partnership) - "U're on Board" Project (Small Grant Program, Ministry of Environment) - Environmental Education at School: A Basis for Sustainable Development (Small Grant Program, Ministry of Environment) - Information Campaign for the Ministry of Environment (ARLA / European Commission) - Reproductive Health in Schools (Ministry of Social Affairs & UNFPA) - SELDAS Project – Strengthening the Environmental Legislation Development and Application System in Lebanon (EU LIFE Program) - Integration of Population & Development in University Curricula (UNFPA University of Balamand)
- Provided comprehensive leadership and academic management for the PHDS program, overseeing strategic planning, enrollment forecasting, budget preparation, and quality assurance of student data and academic records.
- Served as Deputy Chair of the UNESCO-Cousteau-Ecotechnie Chair, supporting interdisciplinary initiatives in sustainability, science, and education.

NGO Co-Founder - Eco Forza, Lebanon

2005

- Co-founded Eco Forza, a non-governmental organization (*Notification 361, 26 December 2005, Ministry of Interior & Municipalities*) focused on environmental sustainability and social impact, driving grassroots action in Lebanon on issues related to waste management, conservation, and public education on environmental stewardship.

Independent Consultant Education, Sustainability, and Development

Various national, regional, and international institutions

2001 - 2019

- Served as a trusted advisor and subject-matter expert on sustainability, environmental education, gender equity, public awareness, and institutional development across a wide range of organizations, including UN agencies, national governments, academic institutions, NGOs, and multinational corporations.

- Designed and implemented high-impact strategies and education programs that advanced sustainable practices, inclusive policy, and public engagement across sectors and regions.
- Key consultancy engagements include: UNEP (Greece) - Led initiatives on public awareness and environmental education in alignment with global environmental goals; UNICEF & UNESCO - Conducted gender reviews and contributed to advancing gender parity and equality in education policy and program design; USAID / Education Development Center (Egypt) - Supported national environmental education and outreach efforts under a U.S.-funded development program; Novartis Pharmaceuticals ME & TetraPak ME - Developed health education and sustainable marketing materials to support CSR and environmental responsibility; Lebanese Parliament & Municipalities - Advised on environmental and community development programs, including waste management and public education; Goguikian Foundation & Arab Forum for Environment & Development - Supported strategic projects on environmental health and youth development; UN Global Compact, American University of Beirut, Lebanese American University, Universite Saint Joseph, Global Affairs Canada in collaboration with Concordia University - Contributed to academic and policy collaborations; National Commission for Lebanese Women - Developed the Education Chapter of Lebanon's Official report to the CEDAW; IREX, USAID - Higher Education Capacity Development Program.

SELECTED GOVERNMENTAL APPOINTMENTS AND REPRESENTATION

- **Member of the Technical Committee for Higher Education Program Evaluation**, Ministry of Education and Higher Education (2017-2021), reviewing and accrediting emerging faculties and programs.
- **Accompanying Head of Diplomatic Mission** (2006-2015), supporting high-level bilateral diplomacy and strategic international engagement on behalf of the Lebanese government.
- **Appointed by Presidential Decree (No. 14415)** as a **Member of the National Commission for Lebanese Women** (2005-2007), contributing to national policymaking on gender equity, development, and governance.
- Represented the Government of Lebanon at **high-level international negotiations**, including Global Environment Facility meetings and multilateral summits, advancing Lebanon's position on sustainability and global environmental commitments.
- **Jury Member on Government Examination Committees**, including Lebanon's Civil Service Board, contributing to transparent, merit-based recruitment in the public sector.
- **Doctoral Committee Jury Member** for various universities, evaluating advanced research in development, public policy, and environmental studies.
- **Member of regional and international research teams**, providing expertise on public policy, education, sustainability, and gender; contributed to collaborative academic and policy-oriented studies across MENA and global forums and **Keynote Speaker** at countless academic and professional conferences on sustainability, education policy, gender, and strategic development, both regionally and internationally.

TV INTERVIEWS AND MEDIA APPEARANCES

- Regular TV interviewee and guest speaker on national and international media platforms, discussing a wide range of topics including education, public health, climate change, biodiversity, and sustainability.
 - Future TV: Desertification & Environmental Education (June 2005 & June 2006)
 - Tele Lumiere: Sustainability & Environmental Education (May 2006)
 - National Broadcasting Network: Environmental Education & Policies (October 2001)
 - Manar TV: Climate Change & Biodiversity (June 2006, June 2007)
 - Tele Liban: Multilateral Environmental Agreements (June 2006)
 - Arab Woman (Heya) TV: Various environmental issues including Climate Change, Biodiversity, and Alternative Energies (Special guest on a weekly basis for 3 months, from October to December 2007)
 - LBCI: Advocacy for Fundraising/Event: Oumeima El Khalil in Concert at AUB
<https://youtu.be/UmoFFIEzVd0> (January 2017)
 - Al Mayadeen: Environmental Awareness amid the Corona virus crisis
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TO_8fTvTPM8 (May 2020)
 - Al Arabi <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5sJgF4LKTQg> (May 2020)
 - Tele Liban <https://www.facebook.com/906181302854782/posts/1738892376250333/> (July 2020)
 - <https://magazine.cioarabmedia.com/2025/arabs-top-sustainability-leaders-driving-the-green-revolution-2025-september-2025/>